

Operating Systems - Pioneer Companies, Timeline & Facts

1. Pioneer Companies & Key Personalities

AT&T Bell Labs (1925) - UNIX (1969) | Ken Thompson, Dennis Ritchie
IBM (1911) - OS/360, AIX | Fred Brooks, Gene Amdahl
Microsoft (1975) - MS-DOS, Windows NT | Bill Gates, Paul Allen, Dave Cutler
Apple (1976) - Mac OS, macOS, iOS | Steve Jobs, Steve Wozniak, Chris Lattner
Digital Equipment Corp (DEC) (1957) - VMS | Dave Cutler
Xerox PARC (1970) - Alto OS | Alan Kay, Butler Lampson
Sun Microsystems (1982) - Solaris | Bill Joy, James Gosling
Google (1998) - Android, Chrome OS | Andy Rubin, Sundar Pichai
Red Hat (1993) - RHEL | Bob Young, Marc Ewing
Canonical (2004) - Ubuntu | Mark Shuttleworth

2. Major OS Timeline

1964 - OS/360 (IBM)
1969 - UNIX (AT&T Bell Labs)
1973 - Alto OS (Xerox PARC)
1977 - VMS (DEC)
1981 - MS-DOS 1.0 (Microsoft)
1984 - Mac OS 1.0 (Apple)
1985 - Windows 1.0 (Microsoft)
1987 - MINIX (Andrew Tanenbaum)
1991 - Linux Kernel 0.01 (Linus Torvalds)
1993 - Windows NT 3.1 (Microsoft)
1993 - Debian Linux (Community)
1995 - Windows 95 (Microsoft)
2000 - Windows 2000 (Microsoft)
2001 - Mac OS X 10.0 (Apple)
2004 - Ubuntu 4.10 (Canonical)
2007 - iOS 1.0 (Apple)
2008 - Android 1.0 (Google)
2011 - Chrome OS (Google)
2013 - Docker Containers
2015 - Windows 10 (Microsoft)
2021 - Windows 11 (Microsoft)
2024 - macOS Sequoia (Apple)

3. Quick Facts for Quizzes

- UNIX was the first OS written in C, making it portable.
- Linux powers >95% of supercomputers in the TOP500 list.
- First GUI OS: Xerox Alto (1973).
- Apple's macOS is UNIX certified.
- MS-DOS was originally called QDOS (Quick and Dirty Operating System).
- Linus Torvalds created Linux in 1991 as a hobby project.
- Windows NT introduced a hybrid kernel architecture.
- Android is the most used OS in the world by device count.
- IBM OS/360 was a turning point in commercial computing.
- Real-time OS examples: VxWorks, FreeRTOS.
- Fuchsia OS by Google uses a microkernel called Zircon.